



The habitable epoch

Very early in the universe, the temperatures were high enough for liquid water to exist on any rocky planet. <https://digit.in/may20-83>



Exotic biochemistries

Some of the possible types of life, that is totally different from all the life as we know it on Earth. <https://digit.in/may20-84>



OMEGA SPORE

Life cycle of a stellar parasite

Aditya Madanapalle | aditya@digit.in

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ere is the life cycle of an utterly alien hivemind. We could obviously not have used the original language, which has

glyphs made up of organic compounds, an ambient form of communication that can travel through many media including air

and water. The words and sentences are four dimensional constructs of these compounds, with the time component difficult to represent in text. It would result in pages and pages of chains of chemical formulae, which would be expensive, at least, in terms of trees killed. We could of course, replace the long chemical chains with shorter terms that are our inventions. Instead of making up words such as woowoos, strizzes and sberogyts for microbes, stars and drones to show their alien-ness, we decided to use human words or the nearest approximations, which is less fun for us, but easier to read for you.

We are the first born, the earliest life forms in the universe, at least the first of any importance. There were primitive single-celled organisms before us, bacteria and the viruses, which cannot really even be called life. We were the first and only one, to ascend in consciousness, learn to communicate, coalesce into a hive-mind, and jump the voids between stars. We are now a single organism, but also a multitude. We are a gestalt made up of various aspects of ourselves, each of which are made up of further grades. We are the architect, the gardener, the cook, the farmer, the engineer, the doctor, the artist, the seer, the warrior and the scientist.

Technology is the secret to our widespread success. We have outsourced all our functions to robots, and these automatons do our bidding. We make all kinds of drones, depending on the environment of the planet. They are built for a variety of situations and can fly, swim, burrow, walk, and some of the hardest ones can even hop between planets, but never between stars. We stay in the